FPFL User Guide

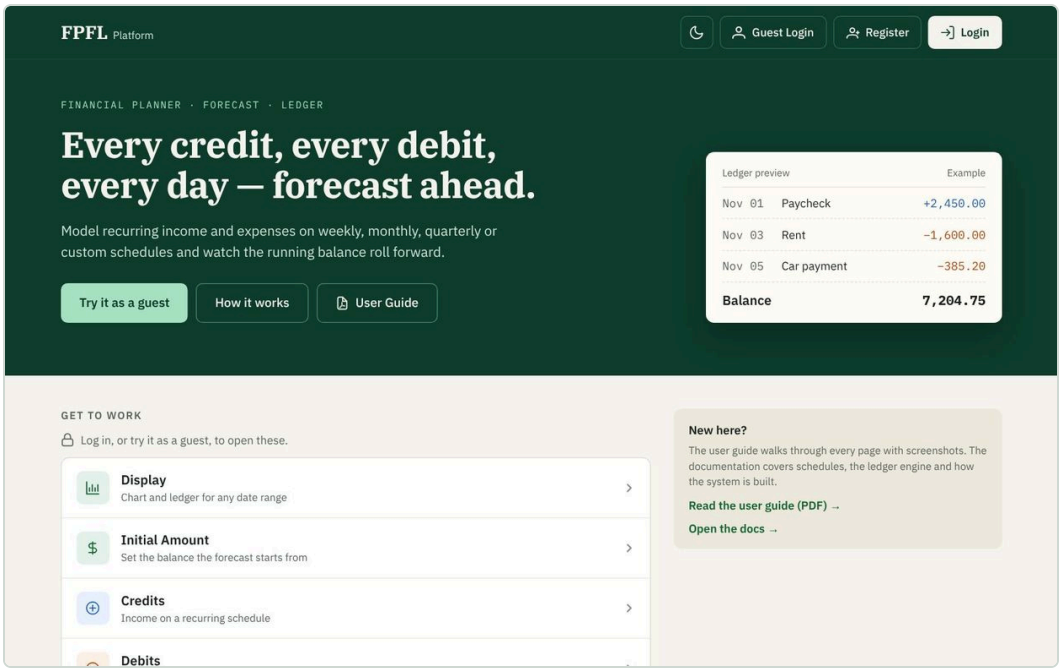
November 8, 2026 · Rick Donalson · ui-tsx.ledger-finance.com

FPFL (Financial Planner Forecast Ledger) forecasts your account balance day by day. Enter a starting balance, your income (credits) and expenses (debits), add any credit cards or loans, pick a date range, and see where your balance will be: as a chart, a ledger, or an Excel workbook.

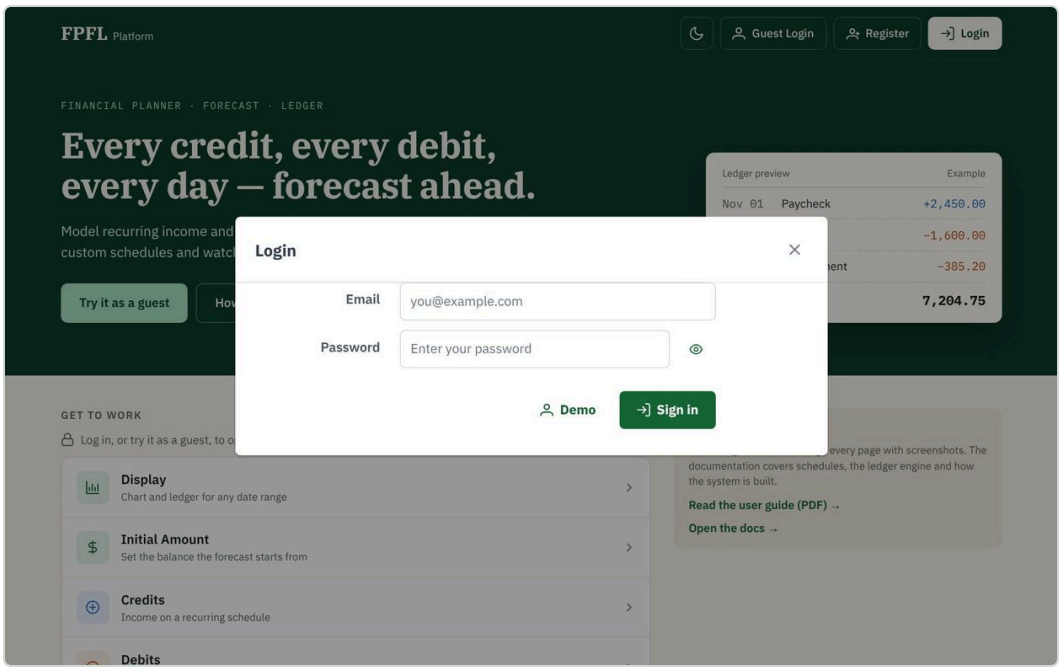
Getting started

Open **ui-tsx.ledger-finance.com**. You can sign in from the top bar or the home page.

- **Guest Login** (or **Try it as a guest**) signs you in to a shared demo account with sample credits, debits and a credit card. No password is needed.
- **Login** signs in to your own account. **Register** creates one: first and last name, email, and a password you type twice.
- **User Guide** opens this guide; **How it works** opens the technical documentation.
- The moon button switches between light and dark mode.

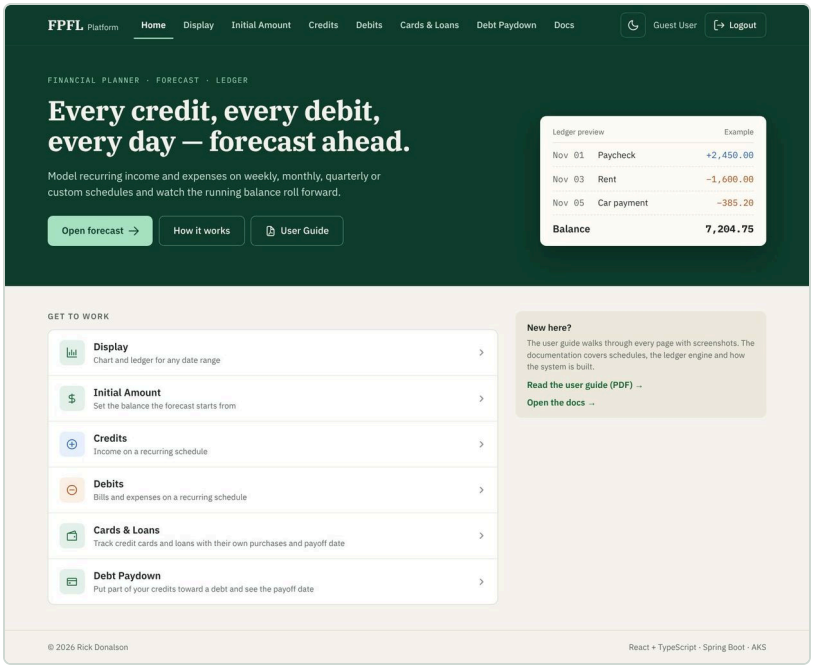


The home page before signing in



The Login dialog. Demo signs in as the guest.

Once you're signed in, the top bar shows a link for every page, your name, **Change Password** (not for the guest) and **Logout**. The home page lists the same pages with a short description of each.



The home page after signing in

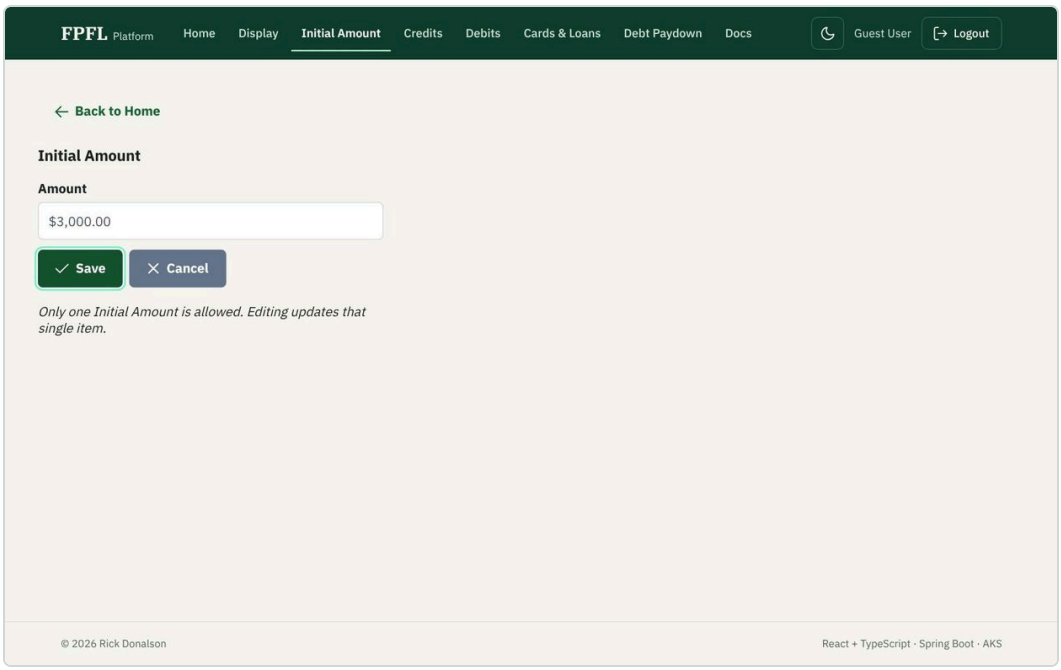
> Your session lasts 15 minutes at a time. Shortly before it ends, a **Session Expiring** dialog asks whether you want to stay. Select **Stay Logged In** to carry on without losing your place.

A good order the first time: set your **Initial Amount**, add your **Credits** and **Debits**, add any **Cards & Loans**, then open **Display** to see the forecast.

Initial amount

Your initial amount is the balance the forecast starts from, usually what's in the account today. Every account has exactly one.

1. Open **Initial Amount** from the top bar or the home page.
2. Select **Edit**, type the new balance, and select **Save** (or **Cancel**).

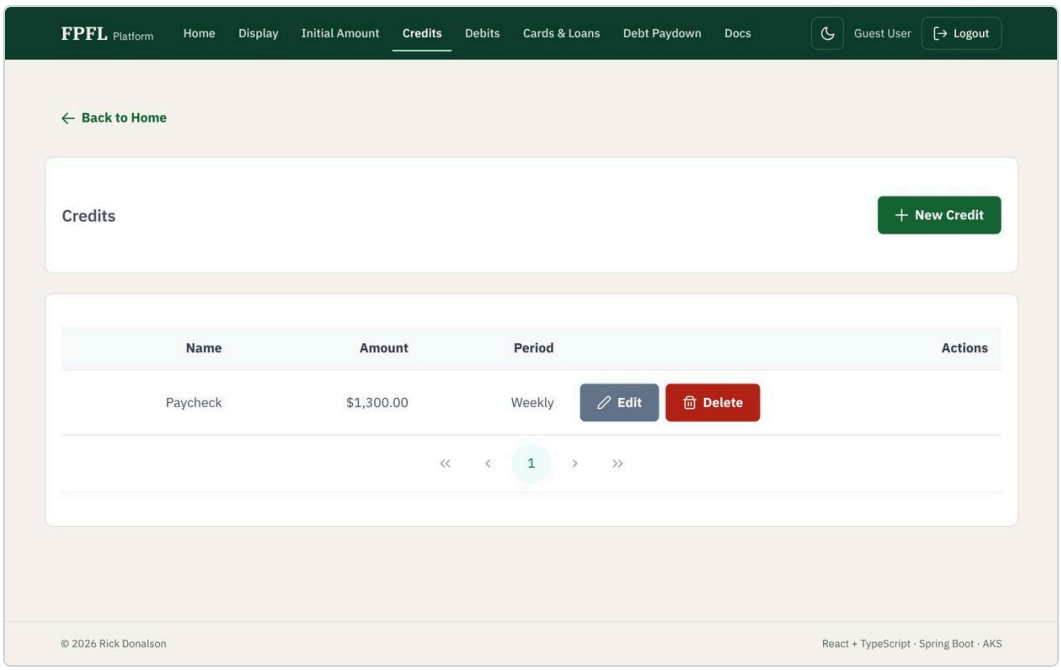


Editing the initial amount

Update it whenever you reconcile your account, so the forecast starts from a true number.

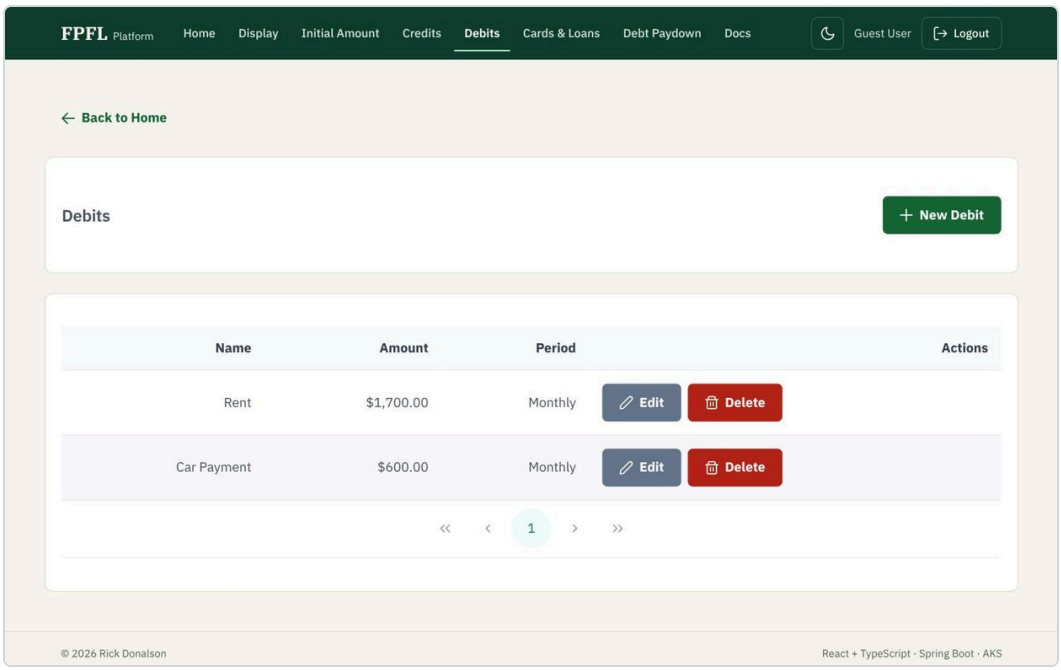
Credits and debits

Credits are money coming in (pay, benefits, refunds, dividends). **Debits** are money going out (mortgage, bills, subscriptions, loan payments). Both pages work the same way.



The Credits list

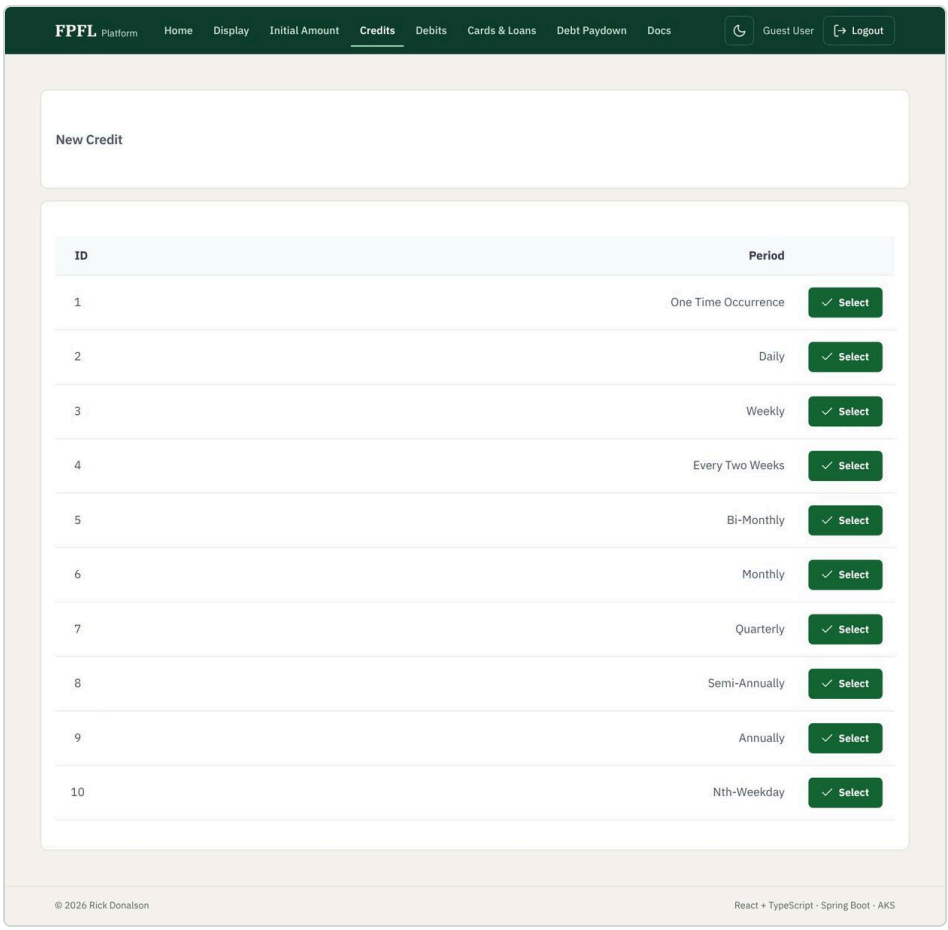
Each row shows the item's name, amount and how often it happens. **Edit** opens the item; **Delete** removes it after you confirm.



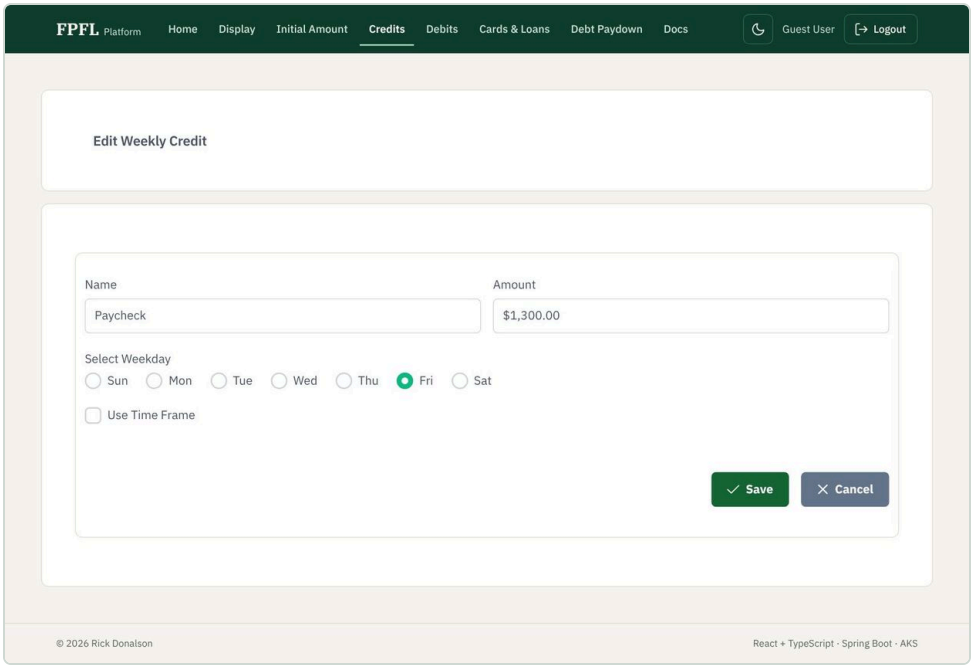
The Debits list

Adding a credit or debit

1. Select **New Credit** (or **New Debit**).
2. Choose how often it happens and select **Select** on that row.
3. Fill in the name, the amount and the schedule for that period, then select **Save**.



Choosing how often a new credit happens



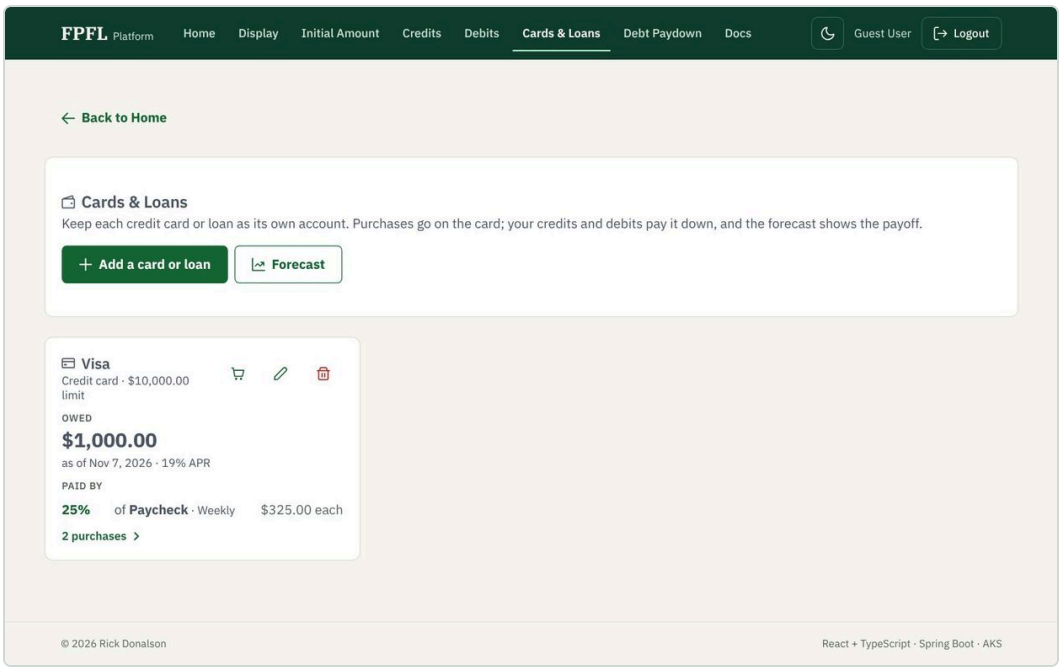
A Weekly credit: a $1,300 paycheck every Friday

Time period	You choose	Example
One Time Occurrence	A date	A tax refund
Daily	Nothing more; it happens every day	A commute
Weekly	A day of the week	Groceries every Saturday
Every Two Weeks	A day of the week and the first date (Inception Date)	A paycheck every other Friday
Bi-Monthly	Two days of the month	Utilities on the 5th and 20th
Monthly	A day of the month	A mortgage on the 1st
Quarterly	Four month and day pairs	Dividends at each quarter's end
Semi-Annually	Two month and day pairs	Car insurance in January and July
Annually	A month and day	A yearly membership
Nth-Weekday	Which week and which weekday	Benefits on the third Wednesday

A day past the end of a short month lands on its last day: "the 31st" is April 30, and Feb 29 is Feb 28 outside leap years. Tick **Use Time Frame** to give an item a start and end date; outside those dates it doesn't appear in the forecast.

Cards & Loans NEW

Cards & Loans keeps each credit card or loan as its own account. Purchases go on the card and raise what you owe; payments from your credits and debits pay it down; interest is charged monthly. Display then shows each balance day by day and when it will be paid off. In the guest account, a **Visa** owes $1,000 at 19% APR with a $10,000 limit, takes $250 of purchases every week plus a $2,000 TV in January, and is paid by a quarter of every paycheck.

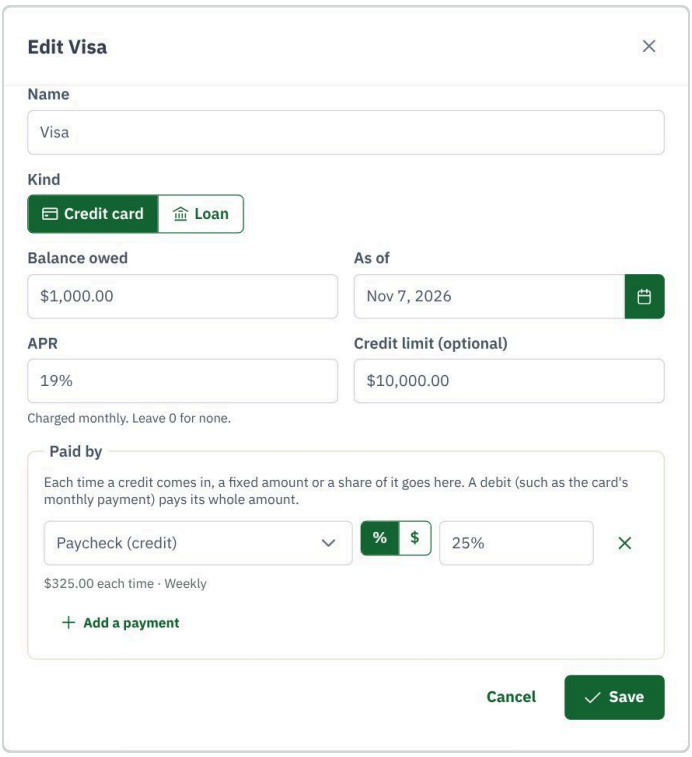


The Cards & Loans page

Each card shows what's owed and as of when, the APR and credit limit, and who pays it. The cart opens its purchases, the pencil edits it and the trash can deletes it (with its purchases) after you confirm. **Forecast** takes you to Display.

To add a card or loan

1. Select **Add a card or loan** and give it a name, such as "Chase Visa" or "Car loan".
2. Choose the **Kind**: **Credit card** or **Loan**. Only a card has a credit limit.
3. Enter the **Balance owed**, the date it was true (**As of**), the **APR** (0 for none; interest is charged monthly), and for a card an optional **Credit limit**.
4. Under **Paid by**, select **Add a payment** and choose a credit or a debit:
   - A **credit** (such as a paycheck) sends a share of each payment: a percentage (**%**) or a fixed amount (**$**). The line underneath shows the dollars sent each time ("$325.00 each time").
   - A **debit** (such as the card's own monthly payment) pays its **whole amount**.
5. Select **Add account** (or **Save** when editing).

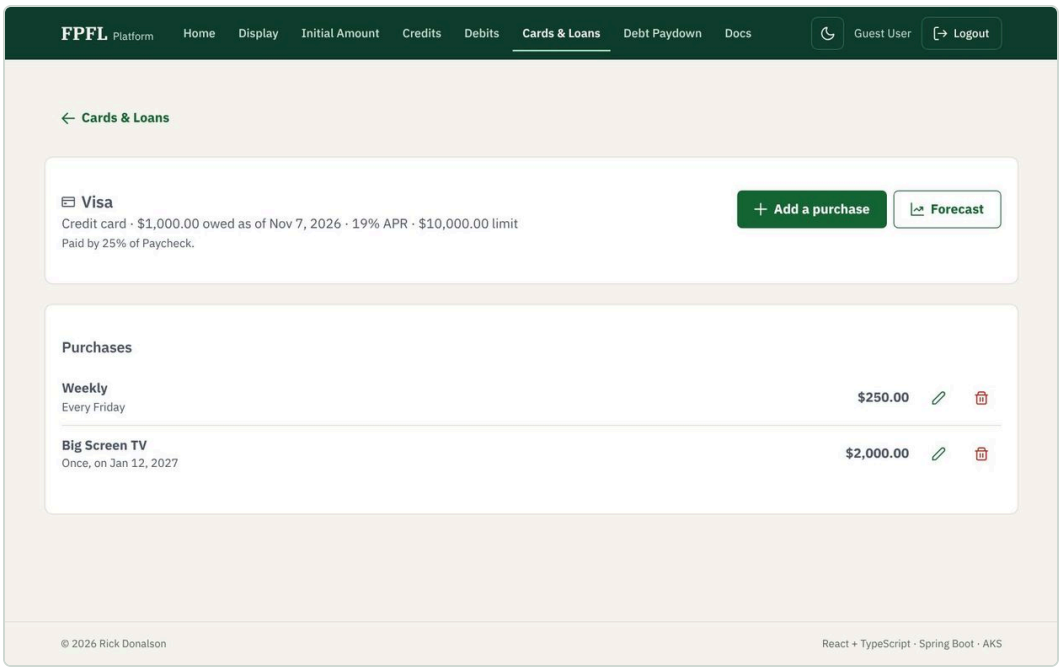


Editing a card: a quarter of every paycheck goes to it

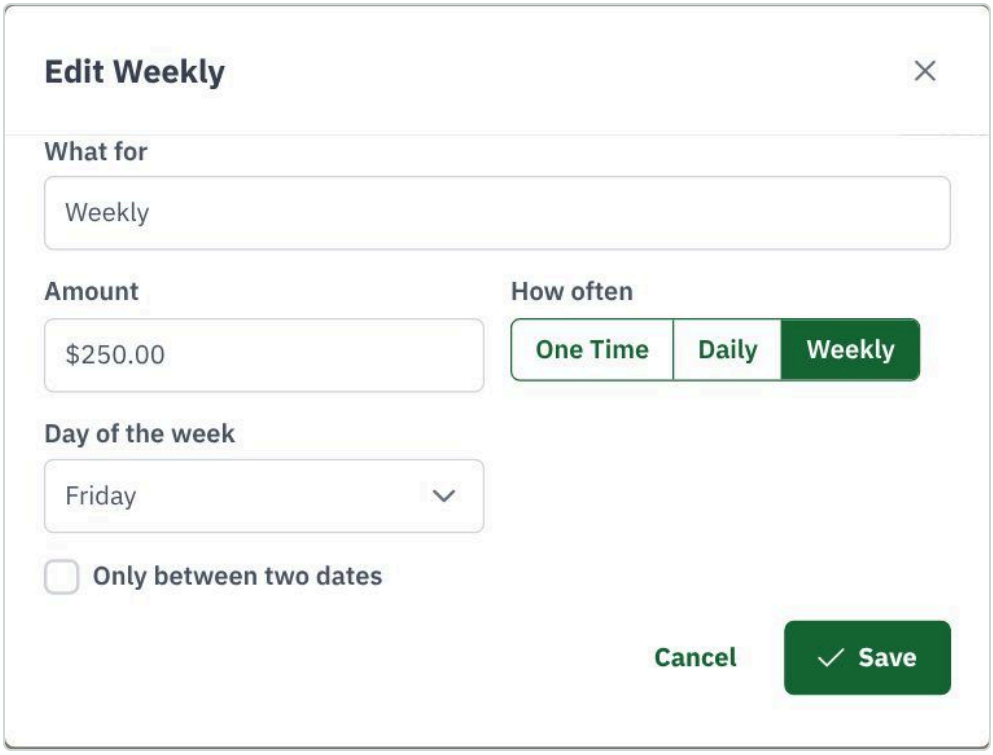
A credit can't be split more than 100% across all your cards and loans; if you try, the dialog says how much is left. Payments also come out of your main forecast, so its balance stays accurate.

Purchases

Select the cart on a card (or its purchases link) to open the card's own page. **Add a purchase** records something you buy on it: what it was for, the amount, and how often (**One Time**, **Daily** or **Weekly**, with the date or day of the week). Tick **Only between two dates** to limit a repeating purchase to a **From**–**To** range. The pencil edits a purchase and the trash can deletes it.



A card's page with its purchases



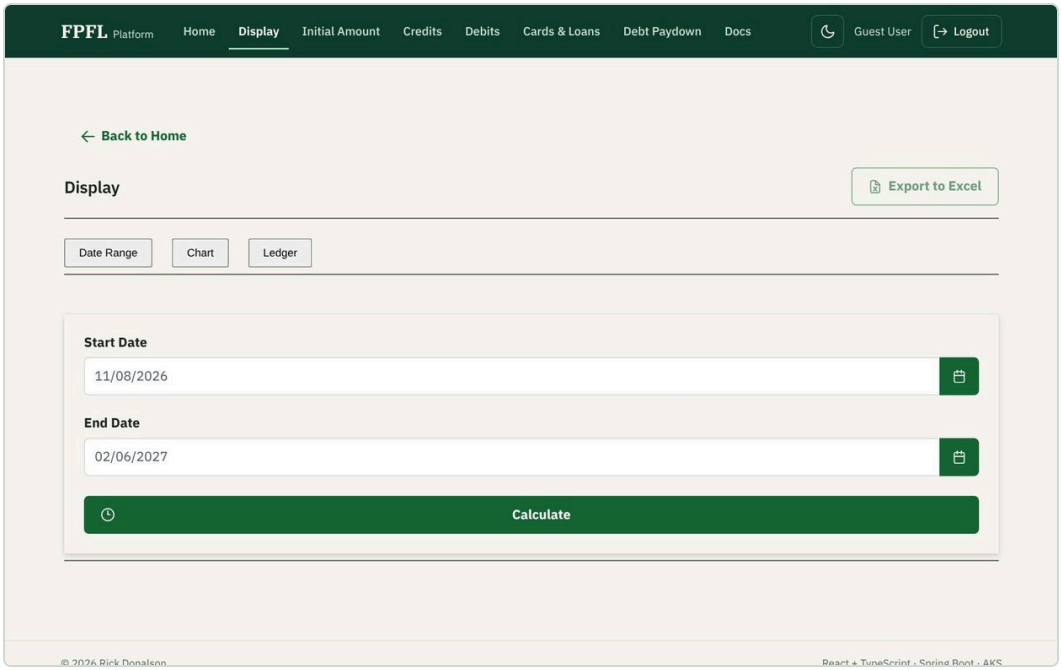
Editing a purchase: $250 every Friday

Display: your forecast

Display shows your balance day by day. It opens on the **Date Range** tab with the next 90 days filled in.

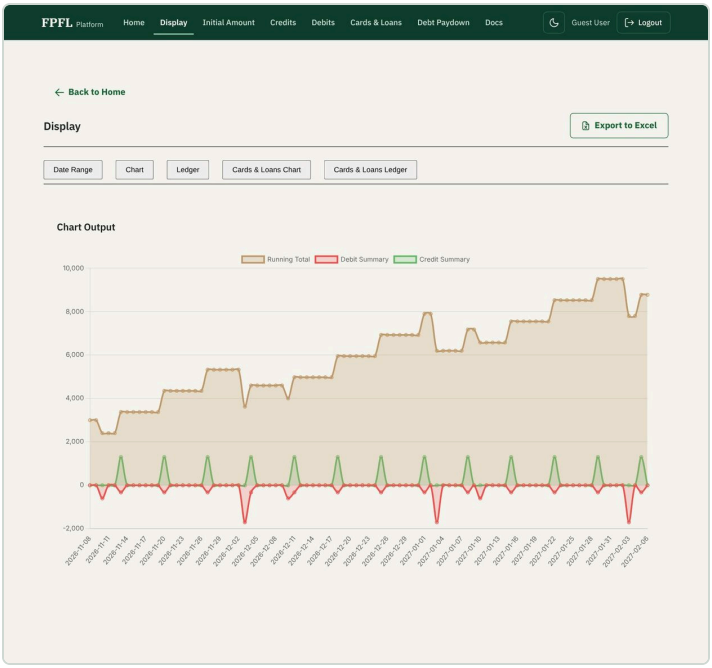
1. Change **Start Date** and **End Date** if you like.
2. Select **Calculate**. The page switches to the **Chart** tab.

3. Use the tabs for the details.



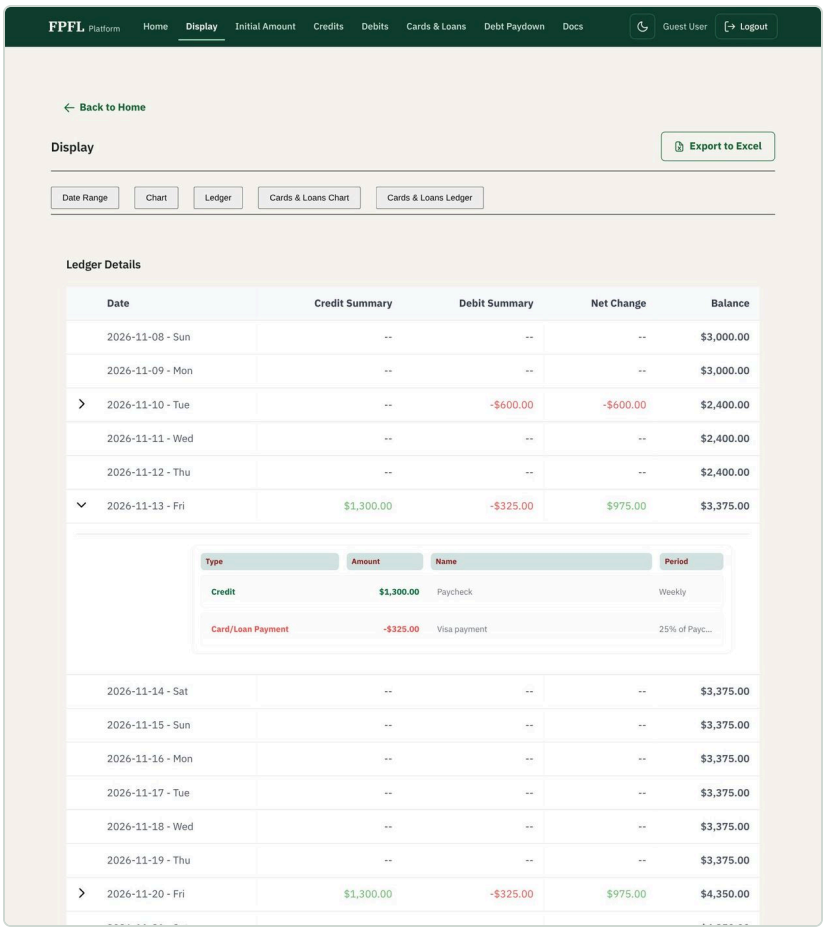
The Date Range tab

Chart plots your running balance (tan) with each day's credits (green, above zero) and debits (red, below zero). Hover over a point for the exact amounts; select a name in the legend to hide or show that line.



The Chart tab

Ledger has one row per day: credits, debits, net change and balance. Days with activity have an arrow; select it to see that day's items. A payment to a card or loan shows as a **Card/Loan Payment** debit named after the card, such as "Visa payment, 25% of Paycheck".

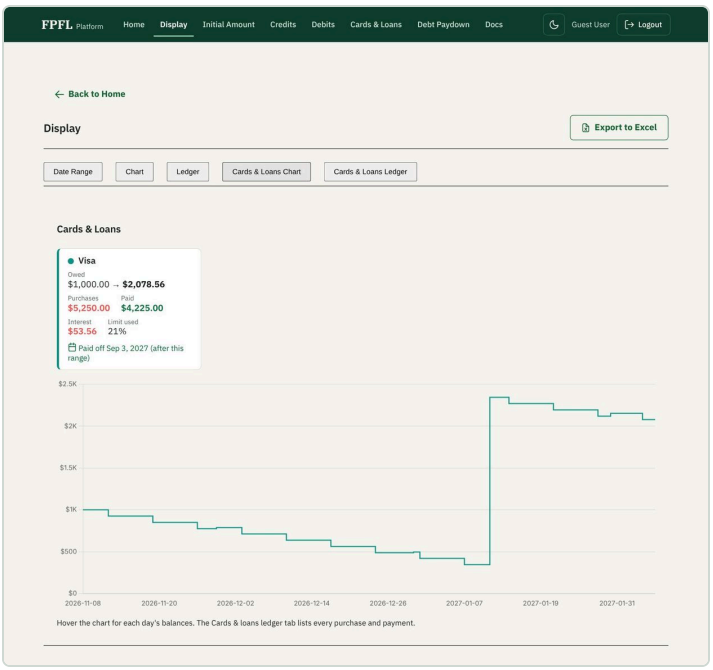


The Ledger tab with Nov 13 expanded: the paycheck and the quarter of it sent to the Visa

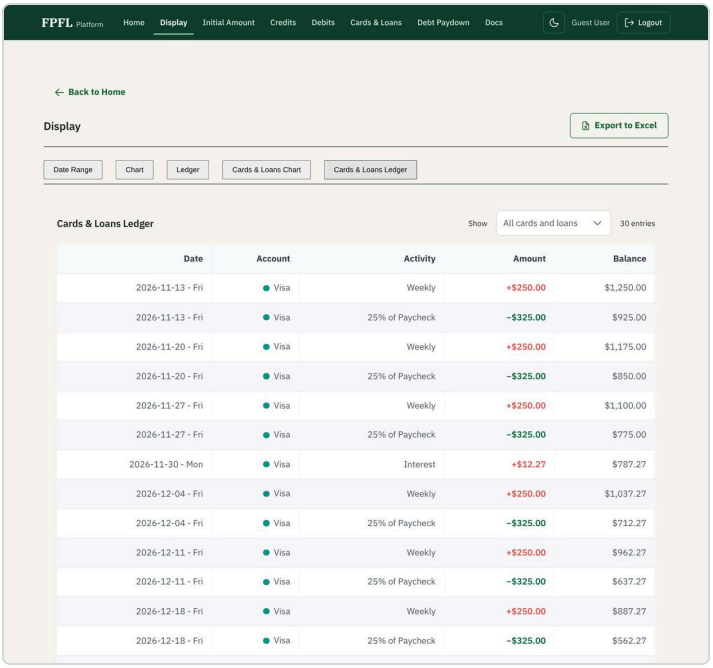
Cards & Loans tabs NEW

Once you have a card or loan, two more tabs appear.

- **Cards & Loans Chart**: a summary per account (owed at the start and end of the range, purchases, paid, interest, how much of the limit is used, and the payoff date) above each balance day by day.
- **Cards & Loans Ledger**: every purchase (+, raises the balance), payment (–) and interest charge, with the balance after it; **Paid off** marks a payment that clears the balance. **Show** filters to one account.



The Cards & Loans Chart tab: the Visa falls $75 a week, jumps with the TV in January, and is paid off on Sep 3, 2027



The Cards & Loans Ledger tab

If a balance won't be paid off within 30 years at the current rate, its summary says so; add a payment or raise a share.

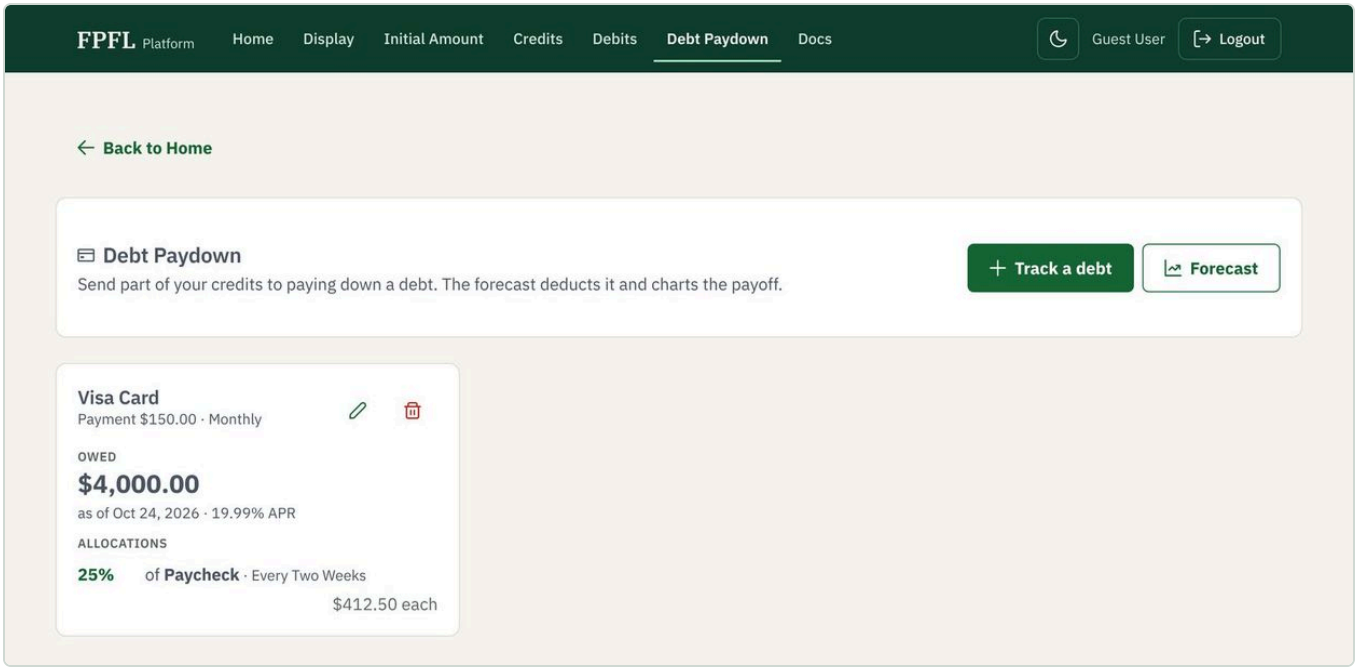
Export to Excel

After you calculate, **Export to Excel** (top right) downloads the forecast as *Forecast Ledger <start> to <end>.xlsx*. The **Ledger** sheet starts with a summary (starting, ending and lowest balance, total credits and debits, and a warning if the balance drops below $0), then one row per day. Each day's items sit in a collapsed

group: open one with Excel's **+** button at the left, or all at once with the **2** button at the top left. With cards or loans there's a **Cards & Loans** sheet, and with tracked debts a **Debt Paydown** sheet, laid out the same way.

Debt Paydown

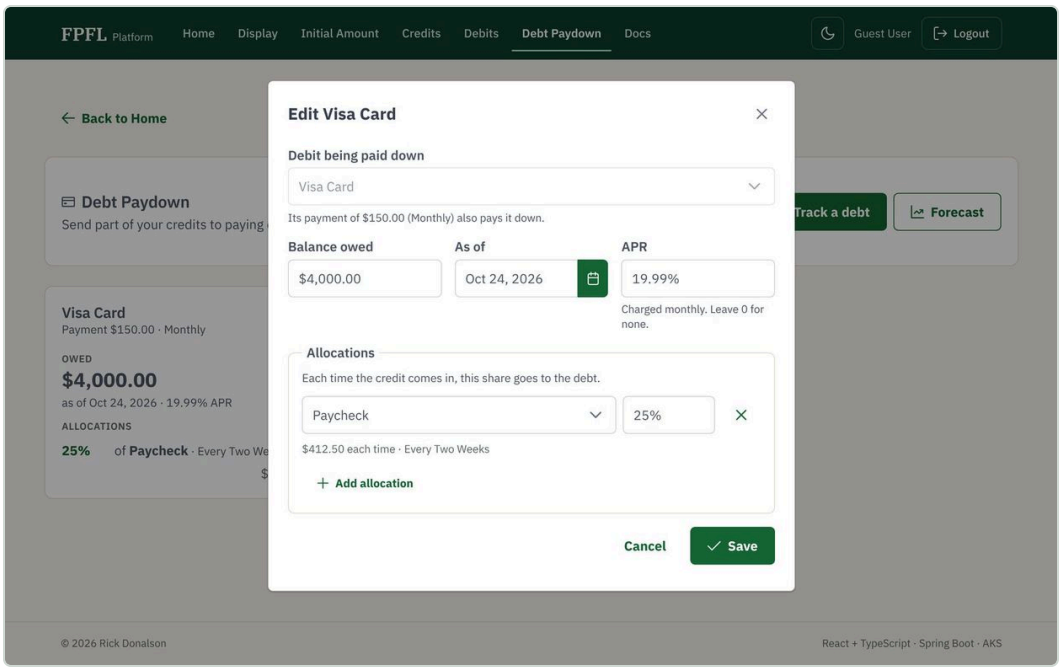
Debt Paydown is the simpler, older way to follow a debt: it tracks a debit you already pay (such as a card's monthly payment) and sends a percentage of your credits toward it. Cards & Loans does all of this and also records purchases, so use it for new cards. The pictures below use an example Visa Card: $4,000 owed at 19.99% APR, a $150 monthly payment, and 25% of each paycheck.



The Debt Paydown page

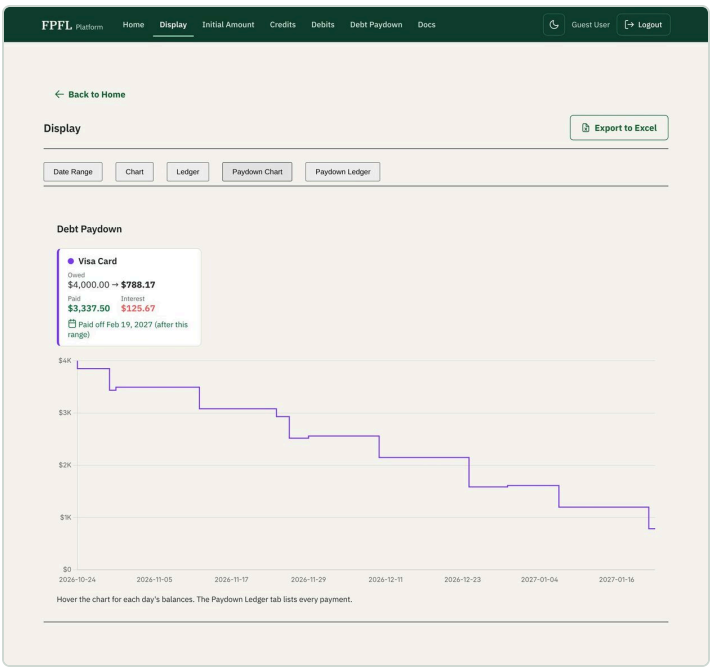
To track a debt

1. Add the debt's regular payment as a debit first, for example "Visa Card, $150, Monthly on the 25th".
2. On **Debt Paydown**, select **Track a debt** and choose that debit under **Debit being paid down**. Its own payment also pays the debt down.
3. Enter the **Balance owed**, the date it was true (**As of**), and the **APR** (0 for none; interest is charged monthly).
4. Select **Add allocation**, choose a credit and a percentage. The line underneath shows the dollars sent each time. Add more credits the same way.
5. Select **Track debt** (or **Save** when editing).

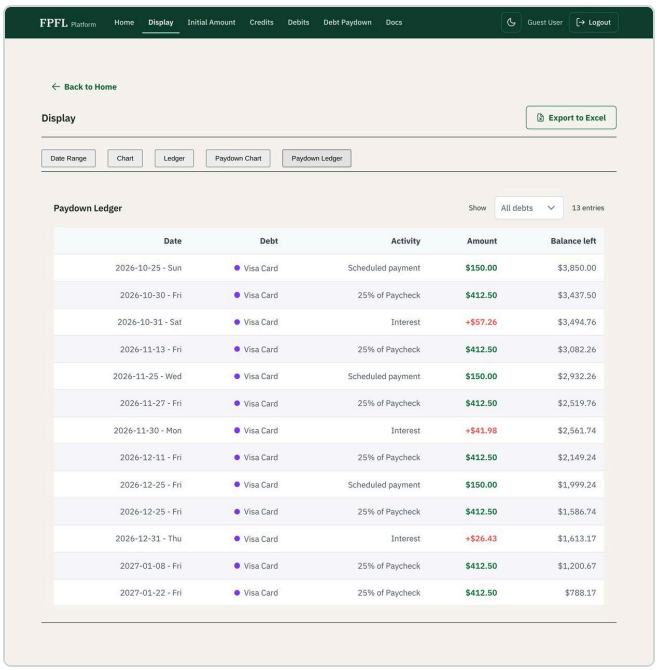


Editing a tracked debt

As with cards, a credit can't be split more than 100% across all your debts. The pencil edits a debt; the trash can stops tracking it but keeps the debit. On Display, a tracked debt adds **Paydown Chart** and **Paydown Ledger** tabs, and money sent to it shows in the Ledger as a **Debt Paydown** debit.



The Paydown Chart tab



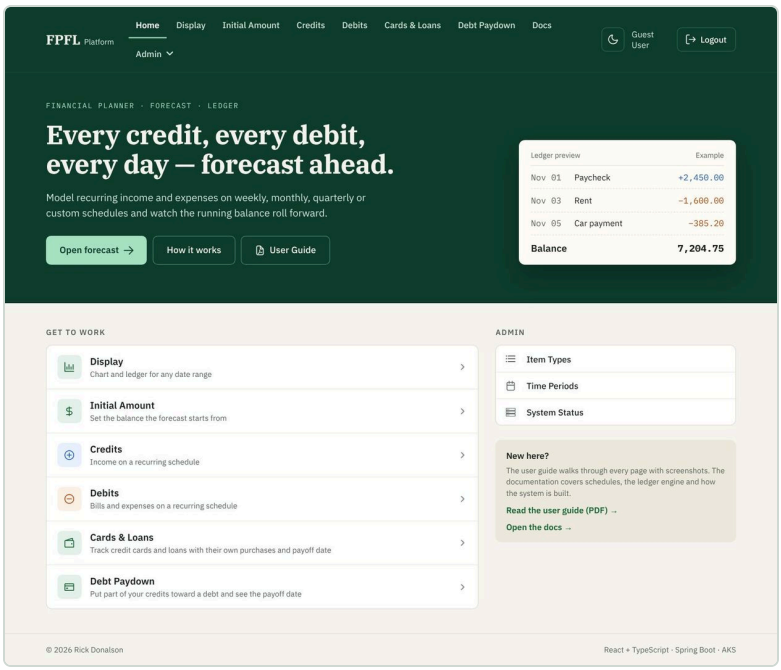
The Paydown Ledger tab

For administrators

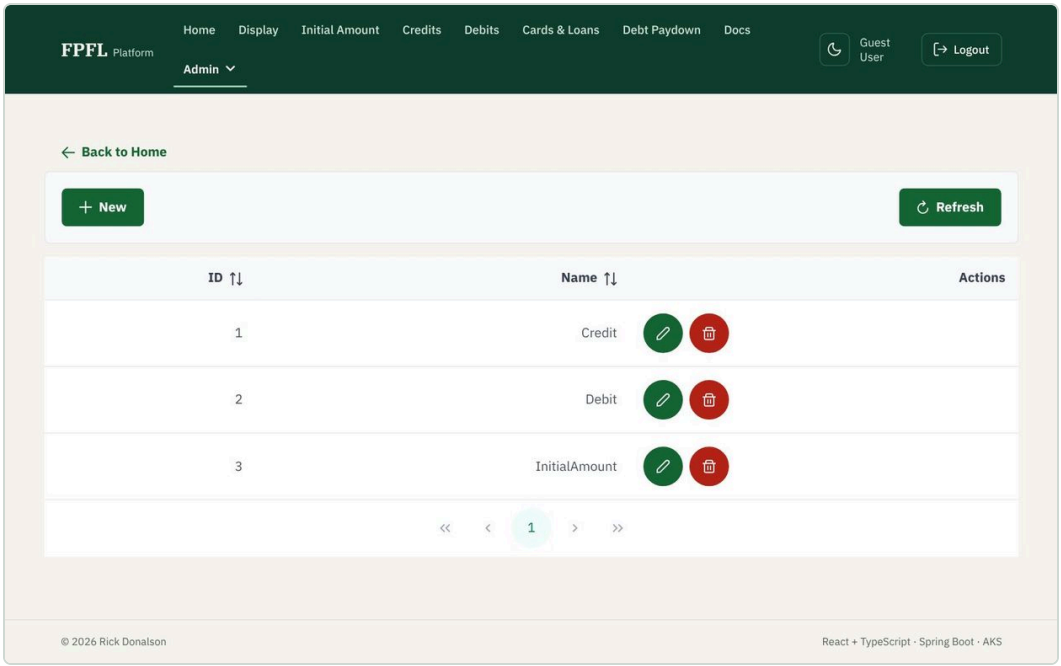
Admins see an **Admin** menu in the top bar and an **Admin** list on the home page:

- **Item Types**: the kinds of items (Credit, Debit, Initial Amount).
- **Time Periods**: the ten schedules in the table above.
- **System Status**: the health of the UI and the API, refreshed every 30 seconds.

On Item Types and Time Periods, **New** adds an entry, the pencil renames one, and the trash can deletes one. Select a column heading to sort.



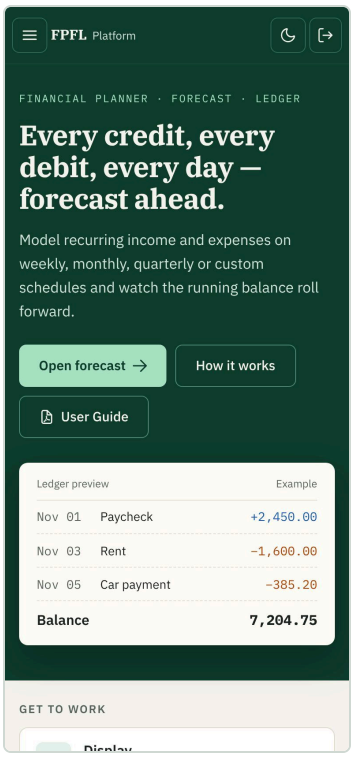
The home page for an admin



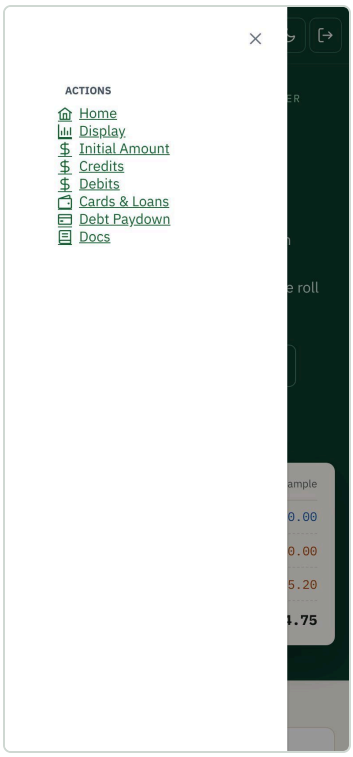
The Item Types list

On a phone

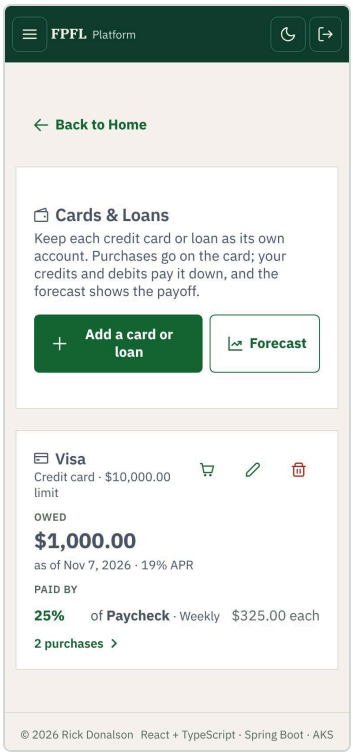
Every page fits a phone screen. The top bar collapses to a ☰ button that opens the menu, and Display's tabs wrap onto more lines. Wide tables scroll sideways.



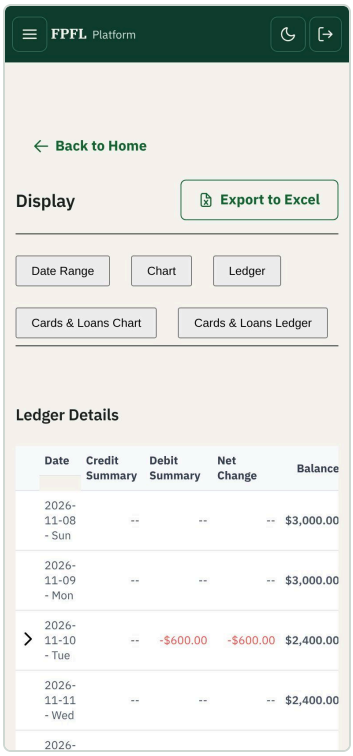
Home



The menu



Cards & Loans



The ledger